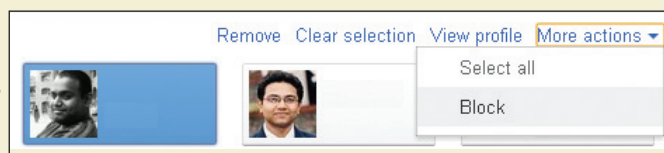


Google +

Whether you've got an invite or not, by now you've probably squeezed yourself in through the Google+ gates. But now that you're there you're probably wondering what the heck to do next. Fear not. These tips and tricks will help you get the most out of your Google+ experience.

Create a blocked circle

If you've ever blocked someone from your Gtalk list, you'll have this circle already present. But if you've never felt the need to so far, Google+ might actually evoke that latent instinct. To create a blocked circle, simply select the people or person you want to block and click the "More actions" dropdown menu at the right

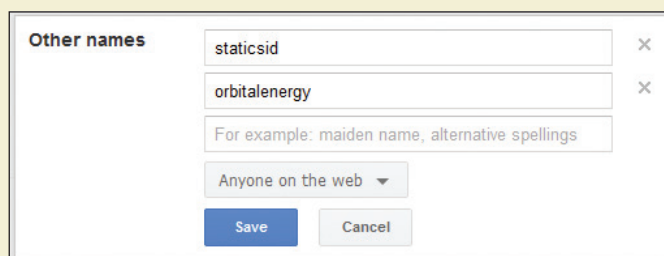


Creating a blocked circle

corner of your Circles screen. Next, click on Block and a new red circle will appear. After this point it's a simple matter of drag and drop.

Let more people discover you

When people first started getting on to the online world, they usually registered with absurd esoteric names like silent_killer666 and what have you. So if you want your old hotmail buddies from your



Letting yourself be discovered by others on Google+ by adding nicknames



Google+.....	51
Steam.....	53
Gmail plugins and enhancements.....	55
Cloud.....	57
Wi-Fi Tips.....	58

Quake III days, who know you as noob_frager123, to discover you, here is a simple way. Click

on Profile > Edit Profile > Other names. Here you can add an entire laundry list of aliases that you may have had before.

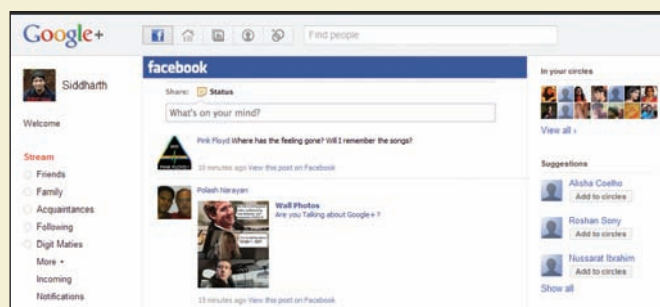
Keep track of what you like with +1s

In the brave new world of Google+ your profile will now start playing an important role in how you're represented on Google products. It's also a place where you can track the things that you've liked on your

set to "Your Circles", which means anyone in your circles including Acquaintances.

Pull Facebook into Google+

Now that Google+ is here keeping up with another social network might become painful. You might miss out on updates from good old Facebook. Unless of course you use Crossrider's Google+Facebook browser extension (available for Firefox and Chrome) to combine your Facebook stream into Google+. Simply download the extension from <http://bit.ly/googfab>, connect to Facebook, and get all the updates on your Google+ Facebook tab. The extension



Using Facebook in Google+

excursions around the interwebs. Click the +1s button on your profile, and you'll see a record of everything you've +1'd (sic).

Tagging tweaks

Yes, well, it's not exactly clear who has the patent on Tagging, but Google+ sure has taken a page out of other social networks and given you this feature straight up. To tag photos click on any photo to get its expanded full-size version and click the Add tag button. Likewise, you can choose who can tag you. Go to Profile > Edit Profile > Photos tab. Here you can add or remove circles from the "People whose tags of you are automatically approved to link to your Profile" menu. By default, it's

adds a Facebook button right next to your home button in the Google+ UI.

Basic formatting hacks

Text posted in Google+ follows most of the universal formatting options followed by other Google products such as GTalk. Enclose text in *Asterisk signs* to make it bold. For italics enclose within _underscores_, and a -dash- for strike through.

Stop auto-upload from Android app

When some of us started mucking around with the Android app early on, we were appalled by the Instant Upload feature. Basically, what it does is upload any picture or video you've clicked from your